

UX Report 3: Khan Academy

Written by: Frame by Frame

Shortened User Experience Questionnaire

Obstructive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Supportive
Complicated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Easy
Inefficient	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Efficient
Confusing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Clear
Boring	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	Exciting
Not interesting	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Interesting
Conventional	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Inventive
Usual	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Leading edge

1. What was tested

Progress was the focus of this session. An exercise set inside Algebra 1 was worked through from the first question to the end screen, watching for where the experience peaked and how it closed (Kahneman et al., 1993).

2. The course page

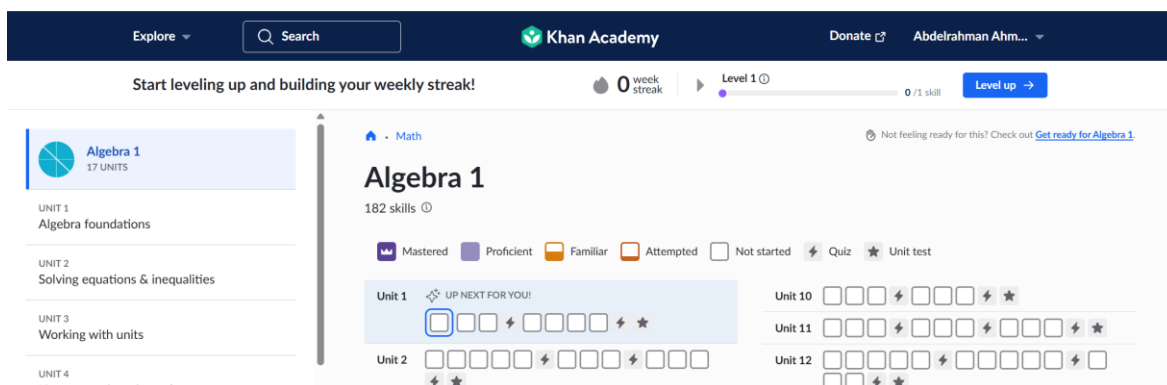


Figure 1: Every skill in the course appears as a small square.

Each skill in the course shows as a square, and colour says how far along the learner is. A legend runs across the top covering mastered, proficient, familiar, attempted and not started. Up next for you marks where to begin. A streak counter and a Level up button sit in the banner above. Seventeen units of empty squares is honest. although it is a cold way to greet someone on day one.

3. Answering a question

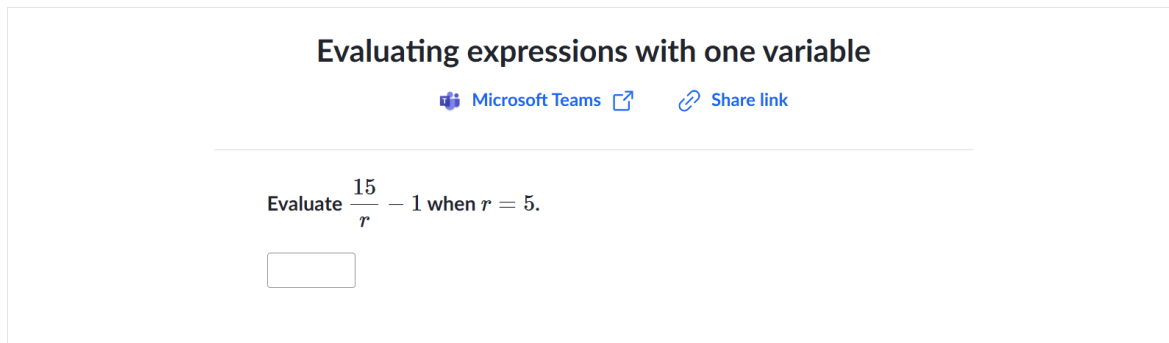


Figure 2: One question, almost nothing else, and seven dots marking the finish line.

A single question fills the screen with very little around it. Seven dots along the bottom show how many problems remain. Which means the set has a visible end before the work starts.

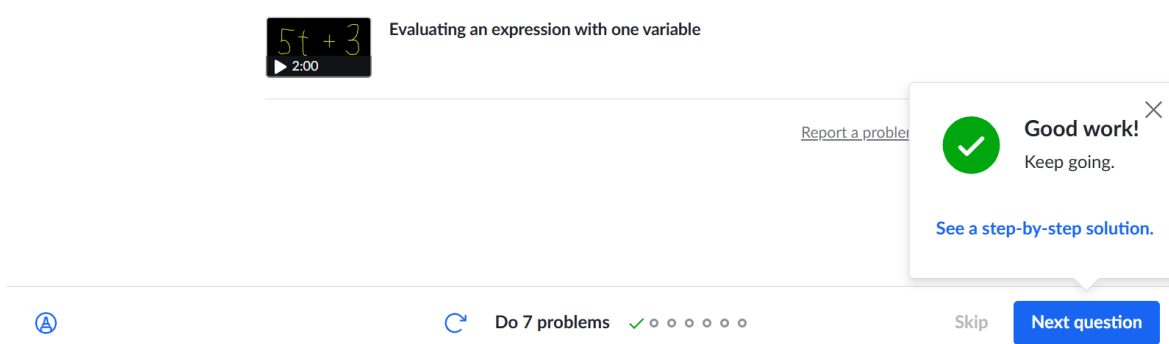


Figure 3: A green tick and two words of praise, then straight on to the next question.

Answering correctly brings a green tick and the words Good work. One dot turns into a tick and the button changes from Check to Next question. Feedback arrives instantly and the reward stays small so it can be repeated without wearing thin.

4. Finishing the set

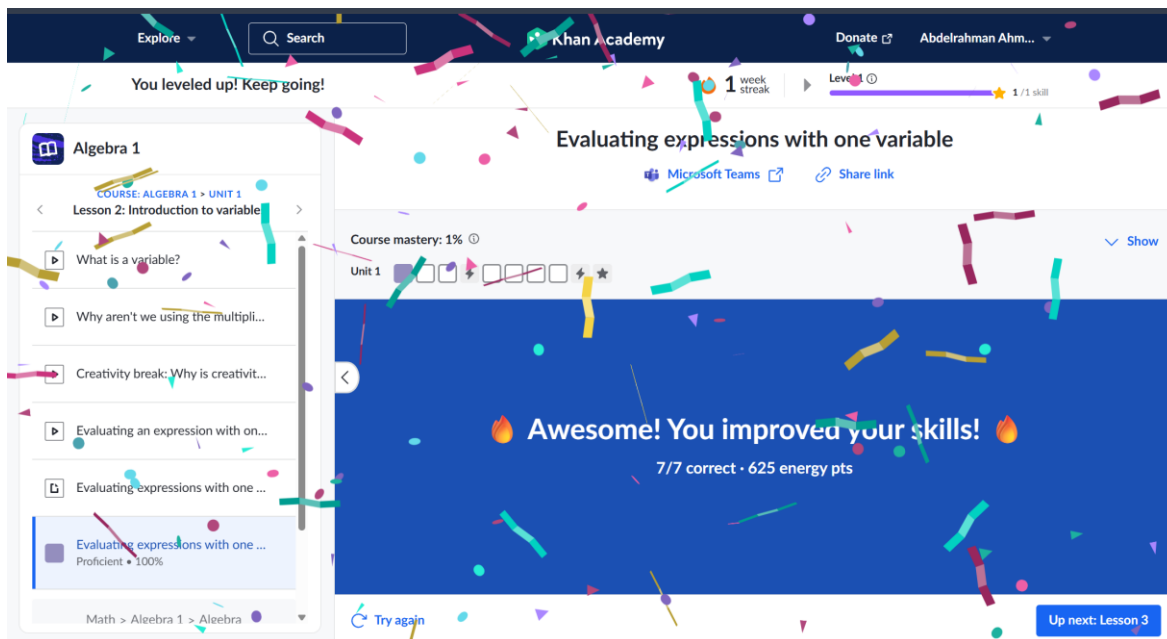


Figure 4: The final question sets off confetti, points, a level-up and a streak at once.

Everything is saved for the last question. Confetti falls across the whole page, a blue panel announces Awesome! You improved your skills! with 7/7 correct and 625 energy points, and the banner above reads You leveled up! Keep going. In the same moment the streak reaches one week, the level bar fills, and the sidebar marks the skill Proficient at 100%. Up next: Lesson 3 waits in the corner.

5. Peak and end

Khan Academy puts its peak and its ending on the same screen, which makes it the clearest use of the rule among the three sites studied. Quiet ticks keep the learner moving through the set and then several rewards land together at the finish. Worth noting is how ordinary the parts are: a colour block, some falling shapes, a number that was earned, and one line of text. None of it needs a large budget.

Its weak spot is the course page. Opening on a grid of empty squares gives a new learner no sense of the win waiting at the end.

6. Takeaways for SkillUP

- Give each small action a short, quiet confirmation, then save the big reaction for the end.
- Mark the end of a section with movement, colour and a number the learner earned.
- Show the finish line before the work begins using dots or a step count.
- Place the next step inside the celebration so momentum carries over.
- Update progress in more than one place at the same time.
- Avoid opening on a screen of empty progress. Show what the first win will be.

References

- Kahneman, D., Fredrickson, B.L., Schreiber, C.A. and Redelmeier, D.A. (1993) 'When more pain is preferred to less: adding a better end', *Psychological Science*, 4(6), pp. 401–405.
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